

SHALON THLARIHANI NGOBENI

Aspiring Data Scientist | Python, SQL, Machine Learning & Data Visualization

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Data Science student with a UCT Data Science with Python certificate and ALX/ExploreAI Academy training in Python programming, data analytics, and professional development. Hands-on experience building end-to-end machine learning pipelines (LightGBM, scikit-learn), AWS-based data engineering projects (Kinesis, Glue, SageMaker, Iceberg, Terraform), and SQL-driven data analysis. Strong foundation in statistical analysis, data visualization (Tableau, Power Query), and OOP-based data pipeline design. Combines analytical rigor with practical problem-solving from prior roles in quality control and operations analysis.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Programming: Python (Pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib, scikit-learn, LightGBM), SQL (MySQL, SQLAlchemy)
- Machine Learning: Supervised learning, regression, classification, model evaluation (RMSE, RMSLE, R^2)
- Data Engineering & Cloud: AWS (Kinesis, Glue, SageMaker, Athena, S3, Iceberg), Terraform, Docker, Delta/Parquet (Bronze/Silver/Gold pipelines)
- Data Visualization & BI: Tableau, Microsoft Excel (Power Query), Google Sheets
- Tools & Practices: Jupyter Notebook, VS Code, Git/GitHub, Google Workspace, OOP pipeline design, data validation & quality assurance
- Soft Skills: Problem-solving, analytical thinking, cross-disciplinary reasoning, communication, adaptability

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Data Science with Python Certificate — University of Cape Town. Core coursework: Statistical Analysis, Machine Learning, Data Visualization. Capstone: Customer Churn Prediction using Machine Learning (2023)

ALX Data Analytics Certificate — 6-month programme covering data analysis with professional development skills for the digital age (Issued Sept 2025)

ALX Python Programming Certificate — 8-week intensive Python programming training (Issued Apr 2026)

ALX Professional Foundations Certificate — Professional development skills for the digital age (Issued Jun 2025)

IBM Data Science Professional Certificate — Focus: Machine Learning with Python, Data Visualization with Python (In Progress, Expected Jun 2025)

SQL for Data Science Professional Certificate — In progress (In Progress)

National Senior Certificate — Thuto Ilesedi Secondary School (2019). Key subjects: Mathematics, Physical Sciences, Life Sciences, Geography. Languages: English (First Additional), Xitsonga (Home Language)

PROJECTS

AWS Financial Lakehouse for Fraud Detection — Designed a Medallion-architecture lakehouse using Kinesis, Glue, Iceberg on S3, Athena and SageMaker, provisioned with Terraform and validated with Great Expectations

Customer Transaction Prediction (Nedbank Zindi Challenge) — Built an incremental LightGBM pipeline to predict customer transaction counts, evaluated using RMSLE

Maji Ndogo Agricultural Data Pipeline — Built a modular Python OOP pipeline (data ingestion, field/weather data processing, validation, and submission) for agricultural data wrangling and EDA

Mutiny x ALX Data Analyst Assessment — Analyzed Instagram Insights and campaign performance for an artist client, building a 13-week KPI growth tracker in Excel with a video presentation of findings

Forest Walk Analytics Project — Used Python and Tableau to analyze participation trends and recommend engagement strategies for quarterly hiking and wellness events

Creator Arena — Designed and maintained databases for contestant records and created visual presentations for event evaluations

WORK EXPERIENCE

Administrative Assistant | Amucan Services

Feb 2024 – Nov 2024

- Organized and analyzed operational data to improve service delivery schedules, increasing efficiency by 10%
- Maintained a structured database of records, invoices, and correspondence to streamline operations
- Conducted trend analysis on service performance to provide insights for strategic planning

Quality Controller | Triton SCS

Oct 2023 – Feb 2024

- Inspected and analyzed product data to ensure compliance with quality standards, achieving a 98% defect-free rate
- Conducted root cause analysis and implemented corrective actions that reduced quality issues by 20%
- Automated reporting processes using Excel to save 8 hours of manual effort weekly

Stock Taker | GRW Engineering (PTY) Ltd

July 2023

- Conducted detailed inventory audits and used data analysis to identify discrepancies, reducing stock variances by 12%
- Generated real-time inventory reports using Excel to support management decision-making

Picker and Packer | Food Lovers Market

Nov 2024 – Present

- Efficiently picked and packed orders based on customer specifications, ensuring accurate and timely fulfillment
- Collaborated with team members to streamline processes, contributing to a 15% improvement in workflow efficiency

Barista | TeaTimes, Greenstone Shopping Center

Oct 2022 – Mar 2023

- Managed inventory tracking systems to optimize stock levels and reduce waste by 10%
- Developed custom dashboards for tracking sales data and beverage preferences

On-Call Storeman | Isanti Glass

2021 – 2023

- Maintained accurate records of inventory levels and monitored stock to avoid shortages
- Generated reports on inventory status and material usage for management review

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- Languages: English, Zulu, Xitsonga
- License: Code 10 Driver's License
- Interests: Continuous learning in data science, health and wellness, community involvement